

**Generative AI in Management Education:
The Use of Generative AI by Master's Students**

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Abstract

This thesis examines how master's students in business and management-related programmes use generative AI, the factors related to their continued use, and the relationship between their use patterns and AI literacy. The study used an exploratory sequential mixed-methods design. It began with three semi-structured interviews, and the findings from these interviews helped shape the survey. The survey drew on UTAUT2 and the AI literacy framework of Ng et al. (2021). After screening the responses, 134 valid cases were included in the analysis.

Many respondents already used generative AI regularly for academic work, with 64.9% reporting use several times a week or more. Habit showed the strongest independent association with Behavioural Intention. Facilitating Conditions and Important Others' Influence were also significantly associated with it. Perceived Benefits were positively associated with continued-use intention, while Perceived Concerns were not. This suggests that students may recognise risks related to AI while still intending to continue using it.

The results for AI literacy showed a different pattern. Frequency of use, tool breadth, and task breadth were not consistently related to the six AI literacy indicators. The regression models for Awareness of AI Limitations and Critical Engagement with AI Outputs were also not statistically significant. Cross-tool Comparison was the only indicator that showed a consistent weak positive relationship with all three measures of AI use. These results suggest that frequent or broad use of generative AI should not automatically be taken as evidence of more critical or responsible use. For management education, AI adoption and AI literacy may therefore need to be considered as related but separate areas.

Keywords: generative AI; management education; UTAUT2; AI literacy; responsible use

1. Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

Over the past few years, generative artificial intelligence (generative AI) has become an important part of discussions about higher education. Since the public release of ChatGPT in late 2022, tools such as ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Google Gemini and Claude have become increasingly common in students' daily learning. Students now use generative AI for far more than searching for information. They ask AI to explain theories, work through difficult problems, summarise journal articles, improve academic writing and organise ideas before starting an assignment (Kasneci et al., 2023; Rahman & Watanobe, 2023).

As generative AI has become more common in higher education, concerns about plagiarism and academic integrity have led some institutions to introduce restrictions. At the same time, other universities have begun to explore how generative AI can be responsibly incorporated into teaching, learning and assessment through updated policies and classroom practices (Halaweh, 2023; Lo, 2023). These different responses reflect the uncertainty surrounding the role of generative AI in higher education. Generative AI is already part of students' everyday learning, but universities are still working out how it can be used without compromising academic integrity or learning quality.

The growing use of generative AI has also raised questions about how critically and responsibly students engage with these tools, an issue often discussed under the term AI literacy (Long & Magerko, 2020). These developments raise different questions across academic disciplines, and business and management education is a particularly relevant context in which to examine them.

1.2 Research Problem

Research on generative AI in higher education has grown quickly since ChatGPT was released. Existing studies have looked at students' acceptance of AI tools, their views on usefulness, the learning opportunities these tools offer, and the problems they raise for academic integrity and responsible use (Strzelecki, 2024; Chan & Hu, 2023; Lo, 2023).

Two limitations in this literature are relevant here. The first concerns who has been studied. University students are usually treated as a single population, and differences between disciplines receive limited attention, so business and management education has been examined much less often. Management students spend much of their time writing reports, analysing business cases, preparing presentations and building recommendations from evidence, and generative AI can support many of these tasks by helping them organise ideas, improve writing and work through information. Easier access does not guarantee better learning outcomes, however. Over-reliance on AI-generated content, which is defined in Section 2.1.4 and discussed in Section 2.3, may reduce the opportunities students have for independent thinking (AlAfnan et al., 2023).

The second concerns how AI use has been studied. Review articles often cover several aspects of generative AI, but empirical studies tend to take one perspective at a time. UTAUT2 has been applied to explain why students adopt these tools (Venkatesh et al., 2012; Strzelecki, 2024). Other studies focus on AI literacy (Long & Magerko, 2020), or on academic integrity and the ethical use of AI (Cotton et al., 2024). These studies are useful, but they usually examine technology acceptance and responsible AI use separately. The relationship between the two therefore remains unclear.

This issue is also relevant to management education. Students may use AI frequently without always using it critically or responsibly. They may also continue using it for many academic tasks even when they are aware of its risks. It is therefore useful to examine how master's students use generative AI, why they continue to use it, and how they understand its limitations. The research questions developed in response to these gaps are presented in Section 2.6.2.

1.3 Research Aim and Motivation

This study focuses on how master's students in business and management programmes use generative AI for academic work. It looks at why students rely on these tools, how they view the benefits and limitations, and how the frequency and breadth of their use relate to AI literacy.

The study has both academic and practical relevance. Academically, it brings technology acceptance, perceived benefits and limitations, and AI literacy together within the specific context of business and management education, so that the reasons for using generative AI and the quality of that use can be considered in a single analysis.

Practically, the growing use of generative AI has led universities and business schools to reconsider teaching, assessment and the responsible use of AI (Halaweh, 2023; Lo, 2023; Cotton et al., 2024). Informed decisions in these areas depend on evidence about how students actually use these tools, instead of on assumptions. The findings reported here may help educators understand students' learning behaviour, and may support the development of AI literacy initiatives, guidelines for responsible use, and assessment practices that reflect the realities of AI-supported learning.

1.4 Structure of the Thesis

The thesis consists of five chapters. Chapter 1 introduces the background, the research problem, the aim of the study and its motivation. Chapter 2 reviews the literature on generative AI, sets out the main concepts and the theoretical framework, and identifies the research gap on which this study is based. Chapter 3 explains the methodology, covering the research design, the interview and survey procedures, and the methods used to analyse the data. Chapter 4 presents the findings from the interviews and the survey, and discusses them in relation to the existing literature and the theoretical framework. Chapter 5 summarises the main findings, considers the theoretical and practical implications, acknowledges the limitations of the study and suggests directions for future research.

2. Theoretical Framework and Literature Review

2.1 Basic Concepts and Definitions

This section explains the main concepts that are used in the study. It first defines generative artificial intelligence and then clarifies the concepts of AI literacy, responsible AI use, academic integrity and over-reliance. Together, these concepts help distinguish between the frequency of students' generative AI use and the extent to which they use these tools critically, transparently and appropriately.

2.1.1 Generative Artificial Intelligence

Generative artificial intelligence (generative AI) refers to AI systems that can generate or transform text and other forms of content in response to user prompts. Well-known examples include ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot and Google Gemini (Kasneci et al., 2023; Peres et al.,

2023). In this thesis, generative AI refers primarily to text-based tools that students use to support academic and learning activities.

2.1.2 AI Literacy

As generative AI becomes more widely used, AI literacy has become an important concept in education. Long and Magerko (2020) define AI literacy as a set of competencies that enables people to critically evaluate AI technologies, communicate and collaborate with AI effectively, and use AI as a tool in different contexts. The specific dimensions of the AI literacy framework adopted in this study are presented and discussed in Section 2.4.1.

2.1.3 Responsible AI Use and Academic Integrity

Responsible AI use generally refers to using AI in ethical, transparent and academically appropriate ways. This includes acknowledging the use of AI when required, critically evaluating AI-generated content and ensuring that AI supports rather than replaces students' own work (Lo, 2023; Sullivan et al., 2023).

Academic integrity is concerned with the boundary between appropriate AI-assisted learning and academic misconduct, such as submitting AI-generated work without disclosure or using AI in ways that breach assessment requirements (Cotton et al., 2024; Sullivan et al., 2023).

2.1.4 Over-reliance on Generative AI

Over-reliance on generative AI refers to situations where students depend too heavily on AI-generated content, which may reduce opportunities to develop their own knowledge and skills (AlAfnan et al., 2023). In this study, over-reliance is treated as a potential risk of generative AI use and is discussed further in Section 2.3.

2.2 Students' Adoption and Use of Generative AI

This section covers the theoretical framework and related empirical literature on students' adoption and use of generative AI. It starts with UTAUT2 (Section 2.2.1), which provides the theoretical basis for RQ1. Section 2.2.2 then reviews prior studies on students' use and acceptance of generative AI in higher education.

2.2.1 Unified Theory of Acceptance and Use of Technology 2 (UTAUT2)

Several theoretical models can be used to explain students' adoption of generative AI. The Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) provides a relatively simple explanation based mainly on perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use (Davis, 1989). However, its limited set of constructs does not fully capture factors such as social influence, facilitating conditions and habit, which may also shape students' use of generative AI. The original UTAUT offers a broader explanation by incorporating performance expectancy, effort expectancy, social influence and facilitating conditions, but it was originally developed in organisational technology-use contexts and does not include habit or hedonic motivation (Venkatesh et al., 2003). UTAUT2 extends the original model to more voluntary and consumer-oriented technology-use contexts by adding hedonic motivation, price value and habit (Venkatesh et al., 2012). These additional constructs make UTAUT2 particularly relevant to this study, which examines not only students' initial adoption of generative AI, but also their repeated and continued use. Its suitability is further supported by Strzelecki (2024), who applied an extended UTAUT2 model to examine university students' acceptance and use of ChatGPT.

Within UTAUT2, behavioural intention is influenced by performance expectancy, effort expectancy, social influence, facilitating conditions, hedonic motivation, price value and habit,

while use behaviour is influenced by behavioural intention, facilitating conditions and habit (Venkatesh et al., 2012).

In this study, UTAUT2 provides a useful framework for understanding the factors associated with master's students' adoption and continued-use intention. The framework therefore informs RQ1 and the development of the related interview questions and questionnaire items.

2.2.2 Previous Studies on Students' Use and Acceptance of Generative AI

Since ChatGPT was released, research has shown that it has quickly become part of how students study. Common uses include brainstorming, summarising readings, explaining difficult concepts and improving written work. Ravšelj et al. (2025), drawing on a global survey of over 23,000 higher education students across 109 countries and territories, found brainstorming, summarising texts and finding research articles to be the most common uses, while professional and creative writing were far less common.

Acceptance tracks closely with how useful students find these tools. Chan and Hu (2023) found that students mainly valued generative AI for personalised learning support, writing, brainstorming, and research assistance. Most respondents also intended to continue using it, although concerns about accuracy, transparency, and academic integrity were common. Similar findings were reported by Ngo (2023), whose participants mainly valued time saving and access to information but also had difficulty judging source reliability. Zhai (2022) reached a similar concern from a different approach, showing that ChatGPT could produce coherent but only partly accurate academic text with little effort, raising questions about assessment.

Strzelecki (2024) tested acceptance using an extended UTAUT2 model to self-reported data from 534 students. Habit was the strongest predictor of behavioural intention to use ChatGPT, followed by performance expectancy and hedonic motivation, and habit also had a

significant direct effect on use behaviour ($\beta = .251$). Behavioural intention had a stronger effect on use behaviour ($\beta = .415$), making it the most important predictor of reported ChatGPT use.

Acceptance is not unconditional. The same studies that report positive attitudes also identify concerns about accuracy and about the point at which AI assistance becomes inappropriate. Ravšelj et al. (2025) found that fewer than 40% of students agreed that ChatGPT could improve their critical thinking, well below the proportions who recognised its usefulness for simplifying complex information or summarising content.

Overall, previous studies show that generative AI has become common in students' study practices, especially because students see it as useful and easy to use regularly. However, it is still unclear whether students who use AI more often also use it more carefully. Ravšelj et al. (2025) discussed this issue through the idea of “AI competency”, referring to students' ability to recognise AI's limitations and evaluate its outputs critically, although this was not measured directly. This study therefore examines whether students' level of AI use is related to their AI literacy, which is discussed further in Section 2.4.

2.3 Benefits, Risks and Learning Impact

Previous studies report several common benefits of generative AI, including saving time, receiving clearer explanations, and completing academic work more efficiently (Chan & Hu, 2023; Ngo, 2023). AlAfnan et al. (2023) found that ChatGPT could support information searching and idea generation in communication and business writing courses. However, they also warned that relying too much on AI to complete assignments may reduce students' opportunities to develop their own skills.

The relationship between AI use and critical thinking is less clear. Essien et al. (2024) studied UK postgraduate business students using Bloom's taxonomy. They found stronger

improvements in lower-order cognitive skills than in higher-order skills, and not all differences were statistically significant. Interview participants also reported mixed experiences: some felt that AI introduced new viewpoints and encouraged fact-checking, while others worried that it could narrow their thinking.

AI use also creates specific issues for students writing in a second language. Warschauer et al. (2023) argue that AI can help these students improve the fluency of their writing, but this may also make it harder to distinguish their own writing from AI-generated text. Liang et al. (2023) further found that AI-detection tools were much more likely to misclassify non-native English writing than native English writing. These findings raise concerns about both academic integrity and fairness.

Tlili et al. (2023) also examined several risks related to ChatGPT in education. Their study included social media analysis, interviews, and testing across different educational scenarios. They found that ChatGPT-generated text could sometimes pass AI-detection tools and that the system could also produce inaccurate information. The authors therefore argued for careful use rather than a complete ban.

It is also important to distinguish between perceived benefits, short-term performance and long-term learning, because these studies do not measure the same thing. Chan and Hu (2023) and Ngo (2023) report how students feel about AI, not what it demonstrably does for them. Essien et al. (2024) measured whether scores changed immediately after an AI-assisted intervention, which is a narrower claim than "AI improves learning". Neither design shows whether anything is retained once the tool is no longer available, and none of the studies reviewed here tests that directly. This limitation should be considered when interpreting the educational value of AI.

2.4 AI Literacy, Responsible Use and Academic Integrity

2.4.1 *The AI Literacy Framework*

Building on the definition introduced in Section 2.1.2, this study uses the AI literacy framework proposed by Ng et al. (2021). The framework includes four main areas: understanding AI, using AI, evaluating and creating AI, and considering its ethical implications. The first two areas focus on understanding what AI can do and how it can be used. The third includes higher-order skills such as evaluating, predicting and designing AI applications. This study does not examine students' ability to design or build AI systems, because the focus is on their use of existing generative AI tools. For this reason, the study mainly considers the evaluative part of this dimension, especially whether students question and assess AI-generated information critically. The fourth dimension covers bias, privacy, transparency and responsible use.

The framework is relevant to generative AI in education because frequent use does not necessarily mean critical use. For example, frequent use of ChatGPT does not necessarily mean that a student is aware that AI can generate false references or inaccurate information. AI literacy involves noticing such problems: checking outputs against reliable sources, revising what the tool produces, and recognising when using it would raise academic integrity concerns.

This thesis applies the framework to examine how carefully and responsibly students use generative AI, with particular attention to whether they understand its limitations, verify the information it provides, and consider the ethical and academic-integrity issues involved. The framework complements UTAUT2. UTAUT2 accounts for the factors behind students' intention to adopt generative AI and their reported use behaviour, while AI literacy accounts for how

critically and responsibly they engage with it once adopted. The two together cover both the extent of adoption and the quality of engagement, which is what this thesis sets out to examine.

2.4.2 Previous Studies on AI Literacy and Academic Integrity

Previous studies connecting AI literacy with academic integrity have focused on disclosure, assessment redesign, and the reliability and fairness of AI-detection tools. Sullivan et al. (2023) analysed news coverage of ChatGPT in higher education and found that most of the public debate centred on integrity concerns and on how assessment might be redesigned; where universities did allow AI use, this was sometimes made conditional on disclosure. Cotton et al. (2024) reached similar conclusions, and their own testing produced a counterintuitive result: OpenAI's GPT-2 Output Detector scored ChatGPT-generated essays close to 100 percent and genuine student essays under 1 percent, suggesting that some detection tools were more capable than their reputation implied.

Liang et al. (2023) found that GPT-detection software regularly misclassifies non-native English writing as AI-generated while performing well on native English text, a fairness problem that matters here, since many management master's students are non-native English speakers. Rudolph et al. (2023), who describe ChatGPT as at times an unreliable "bullshit spewer", nevertheless argue that major changes to assessments such as essays and exams are needed in any case, with a shift toward tasks that require critical thinking and creativity, not recall.

Detection tools are not uniformly unreliable, but their accuracy varies by tool and by writer, which makes them a weak basis for policy on their own. These studies highlight several possible responses, including clearer rules on AI use, changes to assessment design, and greater attention to AI literacy. They also raise concerns about relying heavily on AI-detection tools.

2.5 Generative AI in Management Education

Most studies reviewed so far treat higher education as a single group. Fewer focus specifically on business and management students. This thesis belongs to that smaller group. Essien et al. (2024), discussed above, is one of the few to study AI's effect on critical thinking within a business school specifically, and the fact that its benefits were concentrated in lower-order skills matters for a field that leans heavily on analysis and evaluation. Abdelwahab et al. (2023), surveying 95 business students across 27 Dutch institutions in 2020, found students' overall view of how well their programmes prepared them for AI-driven work was neither positive nor negative, though their view of the curriculum specifically, including whether AI-related seminars or internships were available, was clearly negative. That study predates generative AI and concerns AI readiness in the broader Industry 4.0 sense, so it cannot speak to how students learn to use tools like ChatGPT specifically. It does suggest, though, that management curricula were already lagging behind workplace expectations for AI before generative AI existed as a mainstream tool. AlAfnan et al. (2023), also discussed above, tested ChatGPT's responses to thirty theory-based and application-based tasks in communication and business writing courses. Their tests showed that ChatGPT could support answering theory-based questions, generate ideas, and provide material for classroom discussion. The authors also noted, however, that this makes it harder for instructors to distinguish students who complete work independently from those relying on automation, complicating the assessment of genuine learning outcomes.

These studies suggest that management education is a useful context for examining generative AI use. Case analysis, business writing and decision-making tasks map closely onto

what generative AI does well. Even so, the area remains thin compared with higher education research more broadly, and that gap is what this thesis addresses.

2.6 Research Gap and Research Questions

2.6.1 Research Gap

The literature reviewed in this chapter points to two related gaps, one concerning who has been studied and one concerning how.

The first gap concerns the evidence base. Most existing work on generative AI in higher education draws on broad or mixed-discipline samples, including Strzelecki (2024), Chan and Hu (2023), Ngo (2023) and Ravšelj et al. (2025). Essien et al. (2024) say something specific about business students, but studies of this kind remain uncommon. Abdelwahab et al. (2023) looked specifically at management students, but their data were collected in 2020, before the widespread public use of generative AI, and concern a broader notion of AI readiness tied to Industry 4.0. AlAfnan et al. (2023) address generative AI directly, but tested the tool's own outputs instead of students using it. The available evidence on how master's students in business and management programmes actually use generative AI is therefore limited and largely indirect.

The second gap is analytical. The studies reviewed here tend to examine one piece of the picture at a time. Some apply technology acceptance theory to explain why students adopt generative AI: Strzelecki (2024), for example, identified habit and performance expectancy as important predictors of behavioural intention, and found that both behavioural intention and habit were associated with use behaviour. Other studies examine AI literacy or academic integrity. Ng et al. (2021) focus on how users evaluate AI critically, while Cotton et al. (2024) and Sullivan et al. (2023) discuss responsible use and academic misconduct. Ravšelj et al. (2025) also mention “AI competency”, but do not measure it directly. AlAfnan et al. (2023) examine

what ChatGPT can do, while Essien et al. (2024) look at short-term changes in student performance after AI use. These studies do not show whether students can retain or apply what they learned without AI support. Evidence about students' everyday AI use therefore remains limited.

This thesis addresses both gaps together: a population gap, management master's students studied in relation to generative AI specifically, and an analytical gap, patterns of use and critical and responsible engagement examined in a single analysis instead of through one theoretical lens.

2.6.2 Research Questions

This thesis addresses these gaps through three research questions.

RQ1: How do master's students in business and management-related programmes use generative AI tools, and what factors are associated with their adoption and continued use?

RQ2: What benefits and concerns do students associate with their use of generative AI in academic learning?

RQ3: How are students' reported patterns of generative AI use related to their level of AI literacy?

RQ1 draws on UTAUT2 (Section 2.2) to examine both the pattern of use, which tasks students use generative AI for and how often, and the factors UTAUT2 identifies as shaping adoption, such as performance expectancy, habit and behavioural intention. RQ2 draws on the empirical literature on perceived benefits and risks (Section 2.3) to capture how students experience generative AI, independent of how critically they engage with it. RQ3 draws on the AI literacy framework (Section 2.4) to look at the quality of that engagement: whether students verify what generative AI tells them, recognise its limitations, and use it in ways consistent with academic integrity. Together, these three questions are designed to examine how much master's

students in management education rely on generative AI, what they think of it, and how critically they engage with it, and to explore what relationship, if any, exists among these dimensions.

3. Methodology

3.1 Research Design

This study adopts a two-phase exploratory sequential mixed-methods design. In the first phase, semi-structured interviews were conducted with three master's students in business and management-related programmes, to explore how students describe and account for their use of generative AI. In the second phase, a survey instrument was developed from the theoretical framework presented in Chapter 2 together with the themes identified in the interview data, and was administered to a larger sample of management master's students. The two phases were linked: the qualitative phase was designed to generate insights that could not be anticipated from the literature alone, and several survey items were derived directly from interview findings.

This sequence fits the three research questions set out in Section 2.6.2, which concern both individual experience and broader patterns across a population. RQ1 draws primarily on the UTAUT2 constructs measured in the survey, supplemented by qualitative evidence from the interviews. RQ2 is addressed through both the interview and survey data. RQ3 was examined qualitatively through the interviews and then tested at a larger scale through the survey.

3.2 Target Population and Sampling

The target population comprises master's students enrolled in business and management-related programmes, including general management, strategic management, business administration, and economics and business administration, in which coursework typically emphasises case analysis, business writing, and evidence-based argumentation.

For the interview phase, three participants were selected using purposive sampling, with the aim of achieving variation in academic background and reported AI use. The three participants differed in academic background, programme, prior professional experience, and reported AI use. Detailed participant information is provided in Appendix A.1.

For the survey phase, a target of at least 150 valid responses was set. The questionnaire was built using Credamo and distributed through Credamo, Prolific, personal contacts, and relevant social media groups. Of the 177 responses initially collected, six were identified as ineligible and rejected directly on the survey platform, and could no longer be downloaded; screenshots of these cases are provided separately. The exported dataset therefore contained 171 responses, of which a further 37 were excluded after manual screening of Question 1 on respondents' current programmes. This left 134 valid responses for analysis.

The resulting sample is a non-probability sample of participating management-related master's students and is not statistically representative. This, together with the mix of convenience, snowball, and paid recruitment used to reach it, is revisited as a limitation in Chapter 5.

3.3 Qualitative Stage: Semi-Structured Interviews

The semi-structured interviews were organised around seven thematic areas: academic context and learning experience; experience of using generative AI; motivation for adoption and continued use; perceived benefits; challenges and risks; responsible use and AI literacy; and reflections on the future role of AI in management education. The questions started with general experiences of AI use and then moved to issues such as verification, responsible use and academic integrity. Technical details for each interview and the interview records are provided in Appendix A.

Each interview lasted about 30 minutes and was conducted either in person or online. Participants gave informed consent before the interview and were told about the purpose of the study, how their responses would be used, and their right to skip questions or withdraw. Written records were taken during the interviews, and the analysis process is described in Section 3.5.1.

3.4 Quantitative Stage: Survey Design and Data Collection

3.4.1 Questionnaire Development

The final questionnaire (Appendix B) draws on the theoretical framework in Chapter 2, prior empirical studies, and the interview findings. It has six sections. Section A collects background information, including programme, undergraduate field, work experience, prior AI experience, nationality, gender, age, and language of instruction. Section B covers AI-use patterns, including tools, frequency, tasks, and when respondents started using generative AI. Frequency is measured on a seven-point scale from never to several times a day, adapted from Strzelecki (2024) and Ravšelj et al. (2025). Section C addresses RQ1 through UTAUT2-based items on a five-point Likert scale (items 13–28). Section D addresses RQ2 with four benefit items and five concern items (items 29–37). Section E addresses RQ3 using the AI literacy framework of Ng et al. (2021), covering AI limitations, critical evaluation and verification, and responsible use and academic integrity (items 38–45). Section F contains an optional open-ended question.

3.4.2 Integration of Interview Findings into the Questionnaire

The interviews shaped several parts of the final instrument directly. Participants mentioned network restrictions, paid features, and privacy concerns, which were reflected in the questions on access and privacy.

They also described fabricated references, incorrect information, and checking AI responses against academic or official sources, which shaped the items on accuracy and verification. The interviews also showed that basic AI use was easy, while producing useful academic output and judging its reliability required more effort, which informed the wording of the effort expectancy and AI literacy items.

3.4.3 Survey Administration

The questionnaire was built using Credamo, an academic survey platform based in China, and distributed through the channels described in Section 3.2. The opening page set out the purpose of the research, eligibility, the voluntary nature of participation, data-handling procedures, and contact information for the researcher. Respondents were told the survey was intended for master's students in business and management-related programmes and that their responses would be used only for academic research.

3.5 Data Analysis

3.5.1 Interview Data Analysis

The three semi-structured interviews were organised and analysed using a structured thematic analysis approach. The analysis was based primarily on the three research questions and the theoretical framework set out in Chapter 2, while also retaining other relevant themes that emerged from participants' responses.

Content was organised around the UTAUT2 constructs for RQ1, perceived benefits and concerns for RQ2, and awareness, verification and responsible use for RQ3. Each participant's responses were first organised by interview question and coded into the corresponding themes. The three participants were then compared to identify recurring patterns as well as differences between individuals. Content that fell outside the original theoretical framework but remained

relevant to the research questions, such as network or regional access restrictions, paid features, and language support, was also retained in the analysis.

3.5.2 Quantitative Data Processing and Measurement Construction

Quantitative analysis was conducted using Stata, with a final analytical sample of the 134 valid responses described in Section 3.2. Multiple-response items in the questionnaire were converted into binary variables, coded 1 if an option was selected and 0 otherwise. On this basis, two indicators of the breadth of AI use were constructed: tool breadth, the number of different generative AI tools used by each respondent, and task breadth, the number of different academic activities for which each respondent used AI. Frequency of academic use was measured using a seven-point ordinal scale ranging from never to several times a day.

For constructs measured by multiple Likert items, internal consistency was examined before any composite score was calculated. Cronbach's alpha was used as the primary reliability measure; for two-item indicators, the inter-item correlation was also considered. Items were combined into a composite score, calculated as the mean of the relevant items, only where they showed a reasonable degree of consistency both in theoretical meaning and in their statistical performance. A detailed summary of measurement construction and variable treatment is provided in Appendix B.2.

The two items measuring social influence were not combined into a single score. Although both concern external influence, one reflects the attitudes of important others while the other reflects professors' explicitly stated policies on AI use, and their internal consistency was also low; the two items were therefore treated separately in the subsequent analysis.

The eight AI literacy items were examined using exploratory factor analysis. Factors were extracted using principal-component factoring, with the number of factors determined by

the eigenvalue-greater-than-one criterion and the scree plot, followed by a Promax oblique rotation, which allows the underlying dimensions to correlate. The resulting structure was considered together with the reliability results and the theoretical meaning of each item; the outcome is reported in Section 4.2.3.

3.5.3 Quantitative Analysis by Research Question

For RQ1, patterns of use were described using frequencies and percentages, and the relationship between the UTAUT2 constructs and behavioural intention was examined using Pearson correlations and a multiple linear regression model entering all constructs simultaneously. Variance inflation factors were checked for multicollinearity.

For RQ2, perceived benefits and concerns were analysed descriptively at item level and as two composite scores, and their association with behavioural intention was examined using Pearson correlations.

For RQ3, use was measured through frequency of academic use, tool breadth and task breadth. Spearman rank correlations were used because these variables are ordinal or count-based, and two regression models were estimated for the composite AI literacy indicators. The four single-item indicators were analysed using Spearman correlations only.

All statistical tests were two-tailed, with $p < .05$ as the threshold for significance; correlation coefficients, standardised regression coefficients and overall model fit were considered alongside significance levels.

As the RQ3 analysis was exploratory, no formal correction for multiple comparisons was applied, and interpretation focused on consistent patterns across the three measures of use rather than isolated significant correlations.

3.5.4 Integration of Qualitative and Quantitative Results

For RQ1, interview content concerning the usefulness of AI, ease of use, habit, social influence, and conditions of use was compared with the corresponding UTAUT2 survey results. For RQ2, interview accounts of learning support, efficiency, inaccurate information, over-reliance, privacy, and access conditions were compared with the survey results on perceived benefits and concerns. For RQ3, participants' descriptions of verifying information, awareness of AI's limitations, and responsible academic use were compared with the statistical relationships found between patterns of AI use and AI literacy in the survey.

This integration does not require the two types of data to produce identical results. Where the interview and survey findings show similar patterns, the two sources reinforce and deepen the interpretation of the results; where they diverge, the interview material is used to help explain why such differences might arise.

3.6 Ethical Considerations

Before taking part, all participants were informed of the purpose of the study, what participation involved, and how their data would be used. Participation was voluntary, and participants could withdraw at any point before the interview began or before the survey was submitted.

Participants' real names were not used in the analysis, and the three interviewees are referred to as P1, P2, and P3 throughout the thesis. Quotations and summaries retain only information relevant to the research questions. The survey was anonymous and collected no names, email addresses, or other direct identifiers; background information such as age, gender, nationality and programme was used only to describe the sample and is reported mainly in aggregate form.

The researcher processed and stored the data, which are held securely, used only for this thesis, and will be deleted six months after the research is completed.

Since the study concerns academic integrity, privacy and responsible use, the results are reported without judging individual participants. The analysis addresses students' use experiences and overall patterns, not whether any participant used generative AI "correctly" or "incorrectly".

4. Results and Discussion

4.1 Interview Findings

The interview phase included three students from business and management-related master's programmes. Their backgrounds are summarised in Appendix A.1. The interview findings are organised into four themes: patterns of AI use, reasons for adoption and continued use, perceived benefits and concerns, and AI literacy and responsible use.

4.1.1 Patterns of Generative AI Use

The participants started using generative AI at different stages. P1 began soon after ChatGPT was released and initially used it for writing. After encountering inaccurate references, she shifted more towards language editing, note organisation, and theory support. P2 started using AI when ChatGPT became widely discussed, while P3 used it more often after entering her master's programme.

Their choice of tools was also different. P1 mainly used ChatGPT, Gemini, and Claude and sometimes compared their answers. P2 used DeepSeek, Doubao, Yuanbao, and ChatGPT. P3 mainly used ChatGPT and occasionally Gemini, while Google Scholar and university databases were used for literature searches.

Reported academic uses across the interviews included explaining concepts, organising information, brainstorming, language editing, interview transcription, and interpreting data-analysis results.

4.1.2 Reasons for Adoption and Continued Use

Saving time and getting practical support were common reasons for continued use. P1 mainly valued help with English, new ideas, and efficiency. P2 focused on convenience and time saving, especially because she was studying while working. P3 valued immediate feedback, explanations, and language support.

AI had become part of the participants' study routines, although they did not use it in exactly the same way. P2 described using it as part of her daily routine. P1 and P3 also used it regularly, but usually worked out their own ideas or structure before asking AI for support.

Social influence mainly influenced how AI was used. Friends or classmates sometimes introduced new ways of using AI, while professors' policies affected how carefully students used AI and whether use needed to be disclosed. Access also depended on issues such as network restrictions and paid features.

4.1.3 Perceived Benefits and Concerns

Participants mainly described AI as useful for saving time, understanding difficult content, and getting new ideas. P1 especially valued idea generation and theory explanations with examples. P2 used AI more as support for self-study, while P3 found repeated explanations helpful when working with difficult concepts and English-language materials.

Accuracy was the most common concern. P1 and P3 had both encountered references suggested by AI that they could not verify, and P2 also reported receiving incorrect information.

Other concerns varied. P1 mentioned formulaic writing and dependence on AI, P2 focused on false information and academic rules, and P3 also mentioned privacy.

4.1.4 AI Literacy and Responsible Use

All three participants were aware that generative AI could provide incorrect information, but they checked it in different ways. P1 relied on her own judgement, comparison across tools, and academic sources. P3 checked theories, literature, and numerical information against course materials, academic databases, or official sources. P2 relied more on prior knowledge, intuition, and comparison between AI tools.

Their views on responsible academic use were more similar. They generally saw AI as suitable for explanation, organisation, language editing, and idea development, but not as a replacement for the student's own analysis and understanding. They also recognised that acceptable use may depend on course or university rules.

These differences suggest that frequent AI use does not necessarily mean that students verify information in the same way or have the same understanding of responsible use.

4.2 Survey Results

4.2.1 Sample Description

The final sample included 134 valid responses after the screening process described in Section 3.2. Among them, 69 respondents were female (51.5%), 62 were male (46.3%), two selected “Other” (1.5%), and one preferred not to disclose gender (0.7%). Respondents were aged between 19 and 46, with an average age of 28.89 years ($SD = 6.46$). Before starting their current programme, 47.8% had used generative AI regularly, 44.0% occasionally, and 8.2% had

not used it. The language of instruction was the first language for 59.7% of respondents. Table 4.1 presents the main characteristics of the sample.

Table 4.1. Characteristics of the Survey Sample ($N = 134$)

Characteristic	Category	n	%
Gender	Female	69	51.5
	Male	62	46.3
	Other	2	1.5
	Prefer not to disclose	1	0.7
Prior use of generative AI (before current programme)	Regularly	64	47.8
	Occasionally	59	44.0
	Never	11	8.2
Language of instruction	First language	80	59.7
	Not first language	54	40.3
Relevant work experience	Yes	118	88.1
	No	16	11.9

Note. Age: $M = 28.89$, $SD = 6.46$, range 19–46.

4.2.2 Patterns of Generative AI Use

ChatGPT was by far the most widely used tool (86.6%); the full distribution is reported in Table 4.2. The mean academic-use frequency was 4.91 ($SD = 1.46$), and 64.9% of respondents used generative AI several times a week or more. On average, respondents used 3.27 different AI tools ($SD = 1.24$) and used AI for 5.30 different academic tasks ($SD = 2.06$).

The most common uses were explaining difficult concepts (79.1%), summarising readings (71.6%), and brainstorming ideas (67.2%). Drafting written work (44.8%) and preparing presentations (42.5%) were less common. Most respondents (63.4%) had started using generative AI before their current programme. The main use patterns are summarised in Table 4.2.

Table 4.2. Patterns of Generative AI Use ($N = 134$)

Measure	Category	n	%
Tools used (Q9, multiple response)	ChatGPT	116	86.6
	Google Gemini	83	61.9
	Claude	69	51.5
	Microsoft Copilot	58	43.3
	DeepSeek	53	39.6
	Doubao	40	29.9

Measure	Category	n	%
	Yuanbao	14	10.4
	Other	5	3.7
Frequency of academic use (Q10)	1 Never	3	2.2
	2 Once a month	7	5.2
	3 Several times a month	11	8.2
	4 Once a week	26	19.4
	5 Several times a week	36	26.9
	6 Once a day	33	24.6
	7 Several times a day	18	13.4
Academic tasks (Q11, multiple response)	Explaining difficult concepts	106	79.1
	Summarising readings	96	71.6
	Brainstorming ideas	90	67.2
	Improving grammar or language	83	61.9
	Interpreting data or analysis	80	59.7
	Finding or checking references	78	58.2
	Drafting written work	60	44.8
	Preparing presentations	57	42.5
	Exam revision	50	37.3
	Other	10	7.5
When use began (Q12)	Before this programme	85	63.4
	At the start of this programme	28	20.9
	During this programme	21	15.7

Note. Tools used (Q9) and academic tasks (Q11) were multiple-response items, so percentages sum to more than 100. Tool breadth ($M = 3.27$, $SD = 1.24$) and task breadth ($M = 5.30$, $SD = 2.06$) are the counts of distinct tools and distinct tasks selected by each respondent.

4.2.3 Measurement Reliability and AI Literacy Structure

Before examining relationships among the study variables, internal consistency was assessed for all multi-item measures. The results are reported in Table 4.3. Most measures showed acceptable or moderate internal consistency, while the two Social Influence items showed notably weak consistency.

Table 4.3. Reliability of Multi-item Measures

Measure	Item	N	Min	Max	M	SD	Cronbach's α
Performance Expectancy	Q13	134	2	5	4.34	0.67	.808
	Q14	134	1	5	4.19	0.79	
Effort Expectancy	Q15	134	2	5	4.26	0.74	.687
	Q16	134	2	5	4.25	0.75	
Social Influence	Q17	134	2	5	3.71	0.92	.233
	Q18	134	1	5	3.87	0.94	
Facilitating Conditions	Q19	134	2	5	4.42	0.71	.672
	Q20	134	2	5	4.25	0.74	
	Q21	134	1	5	3.78	1.04	
Hedonic Motivation	Q22	134	2	5	4.24	0.82	.740
	Q23	134	2	5	4.46	0.69	

Measure	Item	N	Min	Max	M	SD	Cronbach's α
Price Value	Q24	134	2	5	4.00	0.90	.718
	Q25	134	2	5	3.97	0.85	
Habit	Q26	134	1	5	4.10	0.98	.633
	Q27	134	1	5	3.97	0.97	
Perceived Benefits	Q29	134	2	5	4.61	0.59	.773
	Q30	134	2	5	4.43	0.70	
	Q31	134	2	5	4.34	0.76	
	Q32	134	1	5	4.19	0.89	
Perceived Concerns	Q33	134	1	5	3.83	1.03	.720
	Q34	134	1	5	3.74	1.15	
	Q35	134	1	5	3.73	1.12	
	Q36	134	1	5	3.37	1.13	
	Q37	134	1	5	3.68	1.13	
Awareness of AI Limitations	Q38	134	2	5	4.31	0.79	.643
	Q39	134	1	5	4.05	1.02	
Critical Engagement with AI Outputs	Q40	134	1	5	4.31	0.89	.778
	Q41	134	1	5	4.45	0.78	

Note. Q42-Q45 were retained as single-item indicators and therefore no internal-consistency coefficient was calculated for these items.

The two Social Influence items had low consistency ($\alpha = .233$) and also measured different forms of influence, so they were analysed separately. Facilitating Conditions had an alpha of .672, slightly below the conventional .70 level. As the items were conceptually related and the value was close to .70, the composite was retained with some caution.

The eight AI literacy items were also examined using exploratory factor analysis. The KMO value was .676 and a three-factor solution was retained, explaining 64.04% of the variance. Based on the factor structure, reliability results, and the meaning of the items, Q38 – Q39 were combined as Awareness of AI Limitations and Q40 – Q41 as Critical Engagement with AI Outputs. Q42 – Q45 were retained as separate indicators.

4.2.4 UTAUT2 Constructs and Behavioural Intention

Behavioural Intention had a mean of 4.34 (SD = .74), indicating a generally high intention to continue using generative AI. Descriptive statistics and Pearson correlations with Behavioural Intention are shown in Table 4.4.

Table 4.4. Descriptive Statistics for UTAUT2-related Variables and Correlations with Behavioural Intention (N = 134)

Variable	M	SD	r with BI	p
Performance Expectancy	4.26	.67	.563	< .001
Effort Expectancy	4.25	.65	.419	< .001
Important Others' Influence (Q17)	3.71	.92	.448	< .001
Professor Policy Influence (Q18)	3.87	.94	.237	.006
Facilitating Conditions	4.15	.64	.513	< .001
Hedonic Motivation	4.35	.68	.559	< .001
Price Value	3.99	.77	.393	< .001
Habit	4.04	.83	.593	< .001
Behavioural Intention	4.34	.74	-	-

All UTAUT2-related variables were positively and significantly correlated with Behavioural Intention, with Habit showing the strongest correlation ($r = .593$). A multiple regression was then used to examine the variables together. The results are presented in Table 4.5.

Table 4.5. Multiple Linear Regression Predicting Behavioural Intention (N = 134)

Predictor	B	SE	Standardised β	p
Performance Expectancy	.173	.099	.157	.083
Effort Expectancy	.015	.094	.014	.871
Important Others' Influence (Q17)	.124	.059	.154	.037
Professor Policy Influence (Q18)	.022	.053	.028	.681
Facilitating Conditions	.220	.108	.192	.044
Hedonic Motivation	.141	.098	.130	.153
Price Value	.006	.078	.007	.934
Habit	.246	.073	.278	.001

Note. $R^2 = .509$; adjusted $R^2 = .477$; $F(8, 125) = 16.18$, $p < .001$; maximum VIF = 2.26.

The overall model was statistically significant and explained approximately 50.9% of the variance in Behavioural Intention. Habit had the largest standardised coefficient among the significant predictors ($\beta = .278$, $p = .001$), while Facilitating Conditions ($\beta = .192$, $p = .044$) and Important Others' Influence ($\beta = .154$, $p = .037$) also remained significant. The other variables did not reach $p < .05$ once the remaining factors were included.

4.2.5 Perceived Benefits and Concerns

Respondents evaluated the academic benefits of generative AI relatively positively, with help in understanding difficult concepts receiving the highest mean ($M = 4.61$). Concerns were

more moderate overall, with accuracy receiving the highest mean ($M = 3.83$). Item-level and composite descriptive statistics are presented in Table 4.6.

Table 4.6. Descriptive Statistics for Perceived Benefits and Concerns ($N = 134$)

Dimension	Item	Item / Measure	n	Min	Max	M	SD
Perceived Benefits	Q29	Helps understand difficult concepts	134	2	5	4.61	.59
	Q30	Saves time	134	2	5	4.43	.70
	Q31	Provides new perspectives	134	2	5	4.34	.76
	Q32	Improves written academic work	134	1	5	4.19	.89
	Q29-Q32	Composite score	134	2.50	5.00	4.39	.57
Perceived Concerns	Q33	Accuracy of AI-generated information	134	1	5	3.83	1.03
	Q34	Over-reliance	134	1	5	3.74	1.15
	Q35	Privacy	134	1	5	3.73	1.12
	Q36	Unequal access	134	1	5	3.37	1.13
	Q37	Reduced independent thinking	134	1	5	3.68	1.13
	Q33-Q37	Composite score	134	1.60	5.00	3.67	.76

The Perceived Benefits composite was positively correlated with Behavioural Intention ($r = .577, p < .001$), whereas the relationship between Perceived Concerns and Behavioural Intention was weak and not statistically significant ($r = -.085, p = .328$). Perceived Benefits and Perceived Concerns were weakly positively correlated with one another ($r = .181, p = .036$). In this sample, stronger perceived benefits were therefore associated with a greater intention to continue using generative AI, whereas having more concerns was not associated with a lower intention to continue using it.

4.2.6 AI Literacy and Its Relationship with Patterns of Use

The AI literacy indicators generally received relatively high scores. Awareness of AI Limitations had a mean of 4.18 ($SD = .78$), while Critical Engagement with AI Outputs had a mean of 4.38 ($SD = .75$); among the single-item indicators, Ensuring One's Own Understanding was highest ($M = 4.44, SD = .69$).

Table 4.7 shows the relationships between the three measures of AI use and the six AI literacy indicators. Most relationships were not statistically significant. Cross-tool Comparison

was the only indicator that showed weak positive correlations with all three use measures: use frequency ($\rho = .185$, $p = .033$), tool breadth ($\rho = .230$, $p = .008$), and task breadth ($\rho = .182$, $p = .035$).

Table 4.7. Spearman Correlations Between AI-use Patterns and AI-literacy Indicators (N = 134)

AI-literacy Indicator	Use Frequency ρ (p)	Tool Breadth ρ (p)	Task Breadth ρ (p)
Awareness of AI Limitations	.027 (.754)	.118 (.175)	.108 (.213)
Critical Engagement with AI Outputs	-.075 (.388)	.015 (.868)	-.083 (.342)
Cross-tool Comparison (Q42)	.185 (.033)*	.230 (.008)**	.182 (.035)*
Disclosure of AI Use (Q43)	.004 (.963)	.161 (.063)	.107 (.217)
Ensuring One's Own Understanding (Q44)	.023 (.796)	.128 (.141)	.086 (.322)
Awareness of Academic-Dishonesty Boundaries (Q45)	-.071 (.416)	.089 (.308)	.019 (.829)

Note. * $p < .05$; ** $p < .01$.

Two additional regression models were estimated for Awareness of AI Limitations and Critical Engagement with AI Outputs. Neither model was statistically significant, and none of the three use measures was a significant predictor. Overall, more frequent or broader use of generative AI was not consistently related to higher AI literacy in this sample. The regression results are shown in Table 4.8.

Table 4.8. Regression Models Predicting the Two AI-literacy Composite Measures (N = 134)

Dependent Variable	Predictor	Standardised β	p
Awareness of AI Limitations	Use frequency	-.019	.843
	Tool breadth	.062	.519
	Task breadth	.064	.533
Critical Engagement with AI Outputs	Use frequency	-.043	.651
	Tool breadth	.085	.377
	Task breadth	-.104	.312

Note. Awareness of AI Limitations model: $R^2 = .010$, $F(3, 130) = 0.45$, $p = .720$. Critical Engagement model: $R^2 = .014$, $F(3, 130) = 0.63$, $p = .598$. Maximum VIF = 1.37 in both models.

4.3 Discussion of Findings

4.3.1 RQ1: Generative AI Use and Continued Use

RQ1 examined how students use generative AI and which factors are associated with adoption and continued use. Habit showed the strongest independent association with Behavioural Intention in the regression model. This is consistent with Strzelecki (2024), who

also found habit to be important in students' continued use of ChatGPT. The interviews supported this result, as participants often described AI as a tool they used regularly when they had difficulties with understanding, writing, or organising information. However, regular use did not always mean that students relied on AI for the whole task. P1 and P3 usually developed their own ideas or structure first and then used AI for support.

Facilitating Conditions and Important Others' Influence were also significantly associated with Behavioural Intention. Interview participants mentioned that network restrictions, paid features, and tool availability could affect access. Friends and classmates sometimes influenced the ways students used AI, while professors' policies mainly affected how carefully they used it and whether they disclosed its use.

Performance Expectancy and Hedonic Motivation were significant in the correlation analysis but not in the full regression model. Their associations with Behavioural Intention may therefore be partly shared with other variables, especially Habit and Facilitating Conditions. Habit remained the strongest independent factor related to continued-use intention.

4.3.2 RQ2: Perceived Benefits and Concerns

RQ2 focused on students' perceived benefits and concerns. Both the interviews and survey showed that students mainly valued AI for understanding difficult content, saving time, and gaining new ideas. Accuracy was the most frequently reported concern.

Perceived Benefits were positively associated with Behavioural Intention, while Perceived Concerns were not significantly related to it. This suggests that students can recognise problems with AI without necessarily reducing their intention to continue using it. In the interviews, participants mentioned risks such as inaccurate information, over-reliance, privacy,

and academic rules, but they mainly responded by checking information, limiting what they shared, or setting boundaries around AI use rather than stopping use completely.

These findings should still be understood as students' perceptions. They show that students believe AI can support learning and efficiency, but they do not prove that AI improves actual learning outcomes or academic performance.

4.3.3 RQ3: AI Use Patterns and AI Literacy

RQ3 focused on whether more frequent or broader use of generative AI was related to higher AI literacy. In most cases, the relationship was weak or not statistically significant.

The interviews showed a similar difference in verification behaviour. P1 and P3 described more structured ways of checking information, while P2 relied more on prior knowledge, intuition, and comparison across tools. Frequent use therefore did not necessarily mean that students evaluated AI-generated information more carefully.

Cross-tool Comparison was the only indicator that showed weak positive relationships with all three measures of AI use. Students who used more tools or used AI for more tasks may simply have more chances to compare different systems. However, comparing AI tools is not the same as checking information against academic or official sources, so this result should not be treated as evidence of higher overall AI literacy.

Overall, the findings support the distinction between AI adoption and AI literacy. UTAUT2 helps explain why students adopt and continue to use AI, while AI literacy concerns how critically and responsibly they use it. In this sample, more frequent or broader use was not consistently related to stronger AI literacy.

5. Conclusions

5.1 Summary of Main Findings

This study used an exploratory sequential mixed-methods design, combining three semi-structured interviews with 134 valid survey responses to address three research questions.

RQ1 showed that generative AI was widely used in students' academic work. In the full model, Habit, Facilitating Conditions, and Important Others' Influence showed significant independent associations with Behavioural Intention, with Habit having the largest standardised coefficient.

RQ2 showed that students recognised both the learning value of generative AI and concerns related to accuracy, over-reliance, privacy, and access. Perceived Benefits were positively associated with Behavioural Intention, whereas Perceived Concerns were not significantly related to it.

RQ3 did not show stable relationships between use frequency, tool breadth, or task breadth and most AI literacy indicators; Cross-tool Comparison was the only indicator showing a consistent weak positive relationship with all three use measures. Extent of use should therefore not be treated as a proxy for AI literacy.

5.2 Theoretical Contribution

The theoretical contribution of this study lies mainly in two areas. First, it applies UTAUT2 to generative AI use among master's students in business and management-related programmes, providing context-specific evidence for this group. Habit, Facilitating Conditions, and Important Others' Influence were showed significant independent association with continued-use intention, while generative AI appeared increasingly embedded in routine academic practice.

Second, the study brings technology adoption and AI literacy into the same analytical framework. Use frequency and breadth were not consistently related to most AI literacy indicators, providing empirical support for distinguishing extent of use from quality of engagement and suggesting that technology-adoption measures should not be used as simple proxies for AI literacy.

This does not imply that the two domains are theoretically independent. Rather, adoption and AI literacy both need to be considered if research is to capture not only whether students use these tools, but also how well they use them.

5.3 Practical Implications

For management education, the main issue is not only whether students use generative AI, but how they use it. The findings suggest that AI literacy should be treated as a separate ability rather than assumed from frequent use.

First, universities can provide clearer guidance on acceptable AI use. The interviews and open-ended survey responses showed that students may be unsure about disclosure, academic-integrity boundaries, hallucinations, verification, and privacy. More specific examples linked to real academic tasks may therefore be more useful than general rules.

Second, AI literacy can be included in existing courses rather than taught only as a separate introduction. Students could be asked to check AI-generated information, compare it with reliable sources, revise AI outputs, and explain how they used AI in assignments. This may help make verification and judgement part of normal academic work.

Assessment practices may also need to reflect the fact that generative AI is already part of everyday academic work. The interviews and Q46 responses suggest distinguishing between handing an entire task to AI and using AI for ideas, language revision, or feedback. Task-specific

rules, short AI-use statements, process records, or oral explanation could help instructors assess whether students genuinely understand the work they submit.

Institutions should also consider access conditions when incorporating AI into teaching. The interviews and open-ended responses raised network, regional, and subscription constraints. Institutional access, alternative tools, and avoiding required premium functions can reduce differences in learning conditions.

Finally, the increasing role of AI does not make traditional academic and professional capabilities less important. The interviews and Q46 responses emphasised judgement, data analysis, oral explanation, and the ability to evaluate AI output. For students studying in a non-native language, assessment should also distinguish linguistic polish from the quality of the underlying analysis.

5.4 Limitations

This study has several limitations. First, the sample was limited in both size and composition. Only three students took part in the interviews, and all of them were female. The survey also did not reach the original target of 150 valid responses, with 134 responses included in the final analysis. The respondents were recruited through convenience, snowball, and paid channels, and the number of participants from different countries was uneven. Therefore, the findings mainly describe the patterns found in this sample and should not be generalised to all management students.

Second, the study used a cross-sectional design, with data collected at one point in time. It cannot show how students' AI use or AI literacy may change over time. The correlation and regression results also show associations rather than causal relationships.

Third, the study mainly relied on self-reported data. What students reported about verification, understanding, and responsible use may not always be the same as what they actually do in academic work.

Finally, generative AI is changing quickly. AI tools, access conditions, subscription models, and university rules may change over time. Some findings may therefore be related to the particular period in which the study was conducted.

5.5 Future Research

Longitudinal research could examine how students' AI use and AI literacy develop over time, and whether the weak relationships found here change as students gain more experience with AI.

Studies with larger and more balanced samples would also make comparisons across countries or regions more meaningful. They could examine whether university policies, access conditions, language background, or academic-integrity rules are related to different patterns of AI use.

AI literacy could be assessed through practical tasks as well as self-report measures. Students might, for example, identify false references, check AI-generated information against original sources, or explain how they verified an AI response.

Another direction would be to test AI-literacy training, such as verification guidance, disclosure rules, or short course modules, and examine whether these approaches improve how students use AI in practice.

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Appendix A. Interview Materials

Appendix A provides the technical details of each of the three semi-structured interviews conducted in the qualitative phase, followed by the full interview records.

A.1 Interview Technical Cards

Participant 1

Date of interview	27 July 2026
Duration	Approximately 30 minutes
Format	In person
Language of interview	English
Programme	MSc International Strategic Management
Institution / country	Lund University, Sweden
Age	28
Gender	Female
Undergraduate background	Finance
Relevant professional experience	Consulting internship
Prior experience with generative AI	Began using ChatGPT shortly after its public release
Informed consent obtained	Yes — verbal consent obtained before the interview began

Participant 2

Date of interview	26 July 2026
Duration	36 minutes
Format	Online
Language of interview	Chinese
Programme	MBA
Institution / country	Beihang University, China
Age	32
Gender	Female
Undergraduate background	Economics (studied in Canada)
Relevant professional experience	Insurance sector
Prior experience with generative AI	Began using generative AI once ChatGPT became widely discussed; had previously used AI to support client proposals at work
Informed consent obtained	Yes — verbal consent obtained before the interview began

Participant 3

Date of interview	27 July 2026
Duration	Approximately 30 minutes
Format	In person
Language of interview	English
Programme	Master's in Economics and Business Administration
Institution / country	Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, Spain
Age	24
Gender	Female
Undergraduate background	Business management
Prior experience with generative AI	Occasional use before the programme; use increased substantially after enrolment
Informed consent obtained	Yes — verbal consent obtained before the interview began

A.2 Interview Records

Participant 1

Section 1. Academic Context and Learning Experience

1. Could you briefly introduce your programme and the kinds of coursework you usually complete?

The participant is studying for an MSc in International Strategic Management at Lund University. Core courses include Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, and Research Methods, with electives in areas such as digitalisation and sustainability. The programme places a strong emphasis on linking theory with practice. Typical coursework includes extensive academic reading, group assignments, company case studies, article analysis, and the master's thesis. Many group assignments are similar to consulting projects: students are expected to contact enterprises or start-ups in Sweden or other countries, understand real business problems, and then use theories and analytical frameworks from class to propose solutions. When reading academic papers, students are also expected to go beyond summarising and critically consider what could be improved and what research gaps the authors may not have addressed explicitly.

2. Which academic tasks do you find the most difficult?

The main challenges are reading and critically evaluating large amounts of literature, contacting companies independently to obtain case material, identifying problems in real business settings, choosing suitable theories and applying them properly, and identifying limitations that the authors of a paper may not have stated directly. For the participant, the hardest part is not memorising knowledge, but connecting abstract theories with complex real-world problems in a meaningful way.

3. What skills do you think are most important for succeeding in your programme?

The participant considers structured thinking the most important skill. Whether doing consulting analysis or academic writing, there needs to be a clear overall structure, clear relationships between arguments, evidence for each point, and a clear reason why one sentence follows another. She specifically mentioned the Pyramid Principle and the MECE principle (Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive). She also believes that linking theory with practice is important: it is not enough to know what theories exist; students also need to judge whether a theory fits a particular case rather than forcing it into the analysis.

Section 2. Experience of Using Generative AI

4. When did you first start using generative AI tools?

She began using generative AI shortly after ChatGPT was launched. At first, she tried using it to support article writing, but later noticed that some of the references it provided were problematic. In the early stage, she therefore used AI mainly for language polishing. As a non-native English speaker, she found AI particularly helpful for English expression.

5. Which AI tools do you use most frequently?

She mainly uses ChatGPT, Gemini, and Claude. She does not rely completely on one tool, but uses different tools for different tasks and compares their responses.

6. For what kinds of academic tasks do you usually use AI?

She mainly uses AI for transcribing and organising interviews, turning scattered material into clearer notes, finding theories that may fit a case, brainstorming, discussing the content and logic of different parts of a paper, explaining theories with examples, and proofreading or polishing academic English. She normally decides the

research direction or writing structure herself first and then uses AI for support.

7. Can you describe a recent situation where AI helped you complete an academic task?

The participant gave an example from a case study on LinkedIn and overseas recruitment intermediaries. From the interviews, she noticed that factors such as US-China relations, tariffs, and supply-chain restructuring were pushing some Chinese companies to move parts of their manufacturing and supply chains to Southeast Asia, while frontline operations and quality-inspection talent there was relatively scattered. She first identified this pattern from the interviews and then asked AI what theory might help explain it. AI suggested “institutional arbitrage”. She then further analysed how Chinese firms may make use of differences in wages, policy stability, and institutions across Southeast Asian countries when organising supply chains, and how LinkedIn may use the local institutional knowledge and talent resources held by overseas recruitment intermediaries to expand its user network. AI mainly provided a theoretical direction; the final theory selection, logic, and conclusions were her own.

Section 3. Motivation for Adoption and Continued AI Use

8. What motivated you to start using AI in the first place?

At first, mainly to improve writing efficiency, especially for language polishing.

9. What made you keep using AI after you first tried it?

There were three main reasons: improving English expression and overall writing quality; supporting brainstorming and suggesting theories or analytical angles she had not considered; and improving the efficiency of interview organisation, theory searching, and language polishing.

10. Would you say using AI has become a habit, something you do without thinking much about it?

She feels AI has largely become part of her normal writing process. She usually builds the overall structure herself first and then naturally discusses with AI what each section should contain and how the ideas should connect. She also asks different AI tools separately because their feedback can vary. So AI use has become habitual, but she still sets the overall direction herself.

11. Do your classmates or professors’ attitudes affect whether you use AI?

They do not strongly affect whether she uses AI, because she thinks she would use it anyway. However, other people’s experiences can influence how she uses it. For example, a friend suggested first asking ChatGPT to improve a prompt, then giving the revised prompt to Gemini and comparing the two responses. She has not tried this yet, but finds the cross-tool approach interesting.

12. What makes you continue using AI? Is it mainly because it saves time and improves your work, because you enjoy using it, or for other reasons?

The main reasons are saving time and gaining perspectives or analytical angles she might not have thought of herself. She values its practical usefulness more than the enjoyment of using it.

13. How easy or difficult was it for you to learn how to use these AI tools effectively?

Basic use is easy because tools such as ChatGPT have a simple interface and only require typing a question. However, getting answers that are genuinely useful, accurate, and suitable for academic work requires learning how to describe the task clearly, provide enough context, and ask follow-up questions.

14. Do you feel you have the knowledge, skills, and resources you need to use AI tools well for your studies?

She has a computer, stable internet access, and access to several free AI tools. She can also use Google Scholar

and the university library to verify information. In terms of skills, she knows how to provide context, ask follow-up questions, and compare AI-generated answers with academic sources.

Section 4. Perceived Benefits

15. What do you find most useful about generative AI?

She finds two things particularly useful. First, AI can raise points she had not considered and broaden her thinking. Second, it can explain theories she does not understand and provide different examples. For example, it can explain “network effects” and distinguish between direct, indirect, domestic, and cross-border network effects, with examples of each.

16. Has AI changed the way you study?

She believes it has changed her study process quite a lot. When she does not understand something, she can keep asking follow-up questions, ask AI to explain it in another way, request more examples, or discuss the connection between theory and cases. When writing, she also discusses content and logic with AI after first creating the structure herself. This has made learning more interactive and easier to explore in greater depth.

17. Do you think AI improves your learning? Why?

She believes it does. AI can provide concrete examples that make abstract theories easier to understand. Within the same amount of time, work completed with AI support is also often better than work completed entirely on her own. She attributes this mainly to clearer theoretical explanations, new analytical angles, improved language, and greater efficiency.

Section 5. Challenges and Risks

18. Have you ever received incorrect information from AI?

Yes. For example, when estimating a country’s population for 2027, if the latest census has not yet been published, AI may simply extrapolate from older data. The result may not be accurate, and AI may not clearly explain the basis of the estimate.

19. Have you ever noticed AI generating fake references or inaccurate facts?

Yes. AI has sometimes generated references that looked realistic but could not be found when she searched the title or citation details on Google Scholar. Because of this, she believes AI-provided references always need to be verified.

20. What concerns do you have when using AI?

Her main concerns are fake references, inaccurate facts, formulaic AI-generated writing, and the risk of becoming dependent on AI after overusing it. AI sometimes uses words she would not normally use or uses dashes very frequently. These things can be edited, but they may weaken a person’s own writing style.

21. Do you think using AI has reduced the effort you put into thinking through a problem yourself?

She thinks it can both increase and reduce independent thinking. On one hand, AI can introduce unfamiliar theories and new applications, which broadens the analysis. On the other hand, she now spends less time repeatedly refining her own wording. She usually decides what she wants to say first and then asks AI to rewrite it in more academic language. So AI has not replaced content-level thinking, but it has reduced some of the effort involved in organising language.

Section 6. Responsible Use and AI Literacy

22. How do you decide whether an AI-generated answer is reliable?

She first judges whether the answer is reasonable based on her own understanding of the project, the topic of

the paper, and the case background. She does not trust an answer simply because it sounds complete. She also considers whether it fits the specific context and compares answers from different AI tools.

23. Do you usually verify the information provided by AI? How?

Yes. She first makes an initial judgement based on her own knowledge, then may ask the same question to different AI tools to see whether their answers are consistent or complementary. She also uses academic databases such as Google Scholar to confirm whether cited references actually exist.

24. What do you think is an acceptable way to use AI in academic work?

She believes acceptable use should still be based on the student's own thinking and judgement. Students can combine their own ideas with AI-generated content, screen and verify the output, and use AI for explanation, expansion, structural improvement, and language polishing. Users should be clear about what they want to say rather than relying completely on AI. She also believes that learning to use AI during one's studies can help prepare for future work.

25. Where do you think students should NOT use AI? Why?

She generally supports using AI and believes even traditional "hard skills" such as programming can benefit from AI assistance. However, client privacy, company data, or other sensitive information should not be entered directly into public AI tools. If a company has an internal AI system, that should be prioritised to reduce the risk of data leakage.

26. Have you ever worried that using AI in a particular way could be considered academic dishonesty? What made you think that?

She believes the key issue is whether AI has replaced the student in producing the core content. If a student first develops their own ideas and basic content and then uses AI to polish the language, she considers that acceptable. But if AI is used to generate the entire paper while the student contributes no real ideas, analysis, or argumentation, she would consider that academic dishonesty.

Section 7. Reflection and Future Expectations

27. Looking back, do you think AI has changed the way you learn?

She believes the change has been substantial. When she does not understand something, she now keeps asking AI questions until it becomes clear. She also uses AI to look for solutions, compare cases, and understand theories. She usually decides the content and structure herself first and then uses AI to discuss the logic, add examples, and refine the language. AI has therefore become a routine support tool for self-directed learning, theoretical understanding, and writing.

28. How do you think AI will influence management education in the future?

She believes management education can still be organised around case-based learning, but the focus should shift from "restricting AI" to "guiding students to engage with AI more deeply". Teachers could provide cases and questions, let students first ask AI, and then require them to ask deeper follow-up questions, observe how AI changes its answers, and reflect on why they asked again or why they thought the original answer was insufficient. In this way, students would analyse not only the case itself, but also the human-AI interaction process and their own thinking. AI could also generate different cases to help students compare and understand theories.

29. If your university could improve one thing related to AI, what would you suggest?

She suggests that universities should not rely too heavily on AI-detection tools or focus only on the "AI

percentage” of an assignment. A more useful approach would be to allow students to use AI but ask them to show or explain the interaction process: why they asked a particular question, how they evaluated the response, what they were dissatisfied with, why they asked follow-up questions, and how they revised the output. Teachers should assess case analysis, theoretical understanding, critical thinking, questioning ability, and reflection rather than only the final answer.

30. Is there anything else about your experience with generative AI that you think is important but we haven’t discussed?

She added that current generative AI is mainly based on large language models, so it performs relatively well on text-based tasks such as writing, theoretical explanation, content organisation, structural improvement, and language polishing, but it is still limited in areas such as PowerPoint design and visual presentation. For example, the structure of consulting-style PowerPoint slides generated by AI is often not as good as what she can build herself. She hopes future AI will provide stronger interactive and scenario-based feedback, such as simulating a client’s questions, reactions, and feedback before a presentation so that users can practise in advance.

Participant 2

Section 1. Academic Context and Learning Experience

1. Could you briefly introduce your programme and the kinds of coursework you usually complete?

She is currently enrolled in an MBA programme. Courses include Organisational Behaviour, Operations Management, Operations Research and Decision-Making, Corporate Finance, Principles of Large Language Models, Business Analytics, Strategic Management, Accounting, Economics, Information Systems for Management in the Digital Age, Financial Accounting, Human Resources, and Marketing Management, among others.

2. Which academic tasks do you find the most difficult?

She finds statistics and operations research courses the most difficult.

3. What skills do you think are most important for succeeding in your programme?

She considers information-search skills and the ability to connect work experience with course content more important than simply learning abstract theory.

Section 2. Experience of Using Generative AI

4. When did you first start using generative AI tools?

She started using generative AI around the time ChatGPT became widely popular.

5. Which AI tools do you use most frequently?

She commonly uses DeepSeek, Doubao, Yuanbao, and ChatGPT.

6. For what kinds of academic tasks do you usually use AI?

She mainly uses AI for business-management assignments, business-planning tasks such as store-opening plans, and text-heavy theoretical assignments such as those related to Marxist theory.

7. Can you describe a recent situation where AI helped you complete an academic task?

After an instructor showed a case video in class and asked students to write a case report, she used AI to help generate report content by combining the case with relevant course concepts.

Section 3. Motivation for Adoption and Continued AI Use

8. What motivated you to start using AI in the first place?

Because it was simple and saved time, especially while balancing MBA study with work.

9–12. What made you keep using AI, has it become a habit, do classmates or professors influence your use, and what makes you continue using it?

She began using AI mainly because it was simple and saved time, especially while balancing MBA study with work. AI has now become part of her daily routine. Classmates' and professors' attitudes have almost no influence on whether she uses it. She continues to use AI mainly because it saves time and helps her complete tasks quickly.

13. How easy or difficult was it for you to learn how to use these AI tools effectively?

Academic use is more difficult than everyday use. Using AI to correct grammar or explain simple concepts is easy, but it becomes much harder when economic models, regression analysis, data, or academic literature are involved, because she still has to judge whether the explanation is correct and verify the data and sources.

14. Do you feel you have the knowledge, skills, and resources you need to use AI tools well for your studies?

Some AI tools cannot be accessed without a VPN.

Section 4. Perceived Benefits

15. What do you find most useful about generative AI?

She finds AI most useful for self-directed learning when she cannot fully follow the content in class, and for resolving questions about assignments.

16. Has AI changed the way you study?

Yes. Previously she took notes manually during class, but now much of the note organisation can be supported by AI.

17. Do you think AI improves your learning? Why?

She believes it does. Because she studies while also working, AI helps improve her learning efficiency.

Section 5. Challenges and Risks

18. Have you ever received incorrect information from AI?

Yes, frequently. She compares responses across different AI tools to help identify errors.

19. Have you ever noticed AI generating fake references or inaccurate facts?

Yes. She has encountered fake references and inaccurate information.

20. What concerns do you have when using AI?

Her main concerns are failing to notice incorrect information from AI and issues related to plagiarism checks and academic rules.

21. Do you think using AI has reduced the effort you put into thinking through a problem yourself?

She does not think AI has significantly reduced her independent thinking because AI-generated content is often quite superficial and still requires her own judgement and input.

Section 6. Responsible Use and AI Literacy

22. How do you decide whether an AI-generated answer is reliable?

She mainly relies on her own intuition and the knowledge she has accumulated through education.

23. Do you usually verify the information provided by AI? How?

Yes. She checks it against her own experience and also compares answers from different AI tools.

24. What do you think is an acceptable way to use AI in academic work?

She believes AI can be used, but its output should not be accepted directly. It first needs to be processed through the student's own thinking and judgement. She also mentioned that schools or workplaces could integrate internal AI systems to help improve information reliability.

25. Where do you think students should NOT use AI? Why?

She believes students should not rely too heavily on AI when writing academic papers, especially when working on a thesis proposal. If they depend on AI too much, they may fail to properly understand the core topic and then find it difficult to continue the research.

26. Have you ever worried that using AI in a particular way could be considered academic dishonesty? What made you think that?

Yes, she has had this concern.

*Section 7. Reflection and Future Expectations***27. Looking back, do you think AI has changed the way you learn?**

Yes, she believes it has changed her way of learning.

28. How do you think AI will influence management education in the future?

She expects more courses related to big data in the future. Many AI-related courses are currently electives but may become compulsory, and instructors may also use more AI-related cases and adopt AI as a teaching aid.

29. If your university could improve one thing related to AI, what would you suggest?

She suggests that the university could provide a safer and more stable way to access overseas AI tools, since some tools cannot be accessed directly in China. She also thinks the university could encourage more interaction and exchange among students.

30. Is there anything else about your experience with generative AI that you think is important but we haven't discussed?

She finds it especially useful that, while reading, she can ask AI about difficult or obscure passages at any time and from anywhere. AI's explanations can also help broaden her perspective.

Participant 3*Section 1. Academic Context and Learning Experience***1. Could you briefly introduce your programme and the kinds of coursework you usually complete?**

She is currently studying for a master's degree in Economics and Business Administration at the Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona. The programme combines economics and business management and focuses quite a lot on analysing real economic and business problems. Courses include economic theory, finance, public policy, and management. Assignments include reading papers, data analysis, individual and group work, presentations, case analysis, research reports, and the final thesis. Some assignments require explaining

economic phenomena, while others use data and economic models. Group work is also common because students come from different countries.

2. Which academic tasks do you find the most difficult?

She finds quantitative analysis, academic reading, and academic writing the most difficult. Quantitative work can be challenging because she needs not only to calculate results but also to understand the relationships between variables and explain them clearly. Academic reading also takes time, especially when economics papers contain difficult language, specialised terms, or mathematical notation. Writing is another challenge because she has had to adapt to expectations around citation, argumentation, and critical analysis. Compared with her previous study experience, she now needs to explain why she chose a particular approach, what evidence supports it, and whether other explanations are possible.

3. What skills do you think are most important for succeeding in your programme?

She thinks analytical ability, quantitative skills, and critical thinking are the most important. Students should not just memorise definitions; they need to decide whether a theory can explain a real problem and whether the data actually supports the conclusion. Time management is also important because reading, data analysis, group work, and the thesis often overlap. Communication matters too, because classmates come from different countries and may approach the same problem in different ways.

Section 2. Experience of Using Generative AI

4. When did you first start using generative AI tools seriously?

She started using generative AI much more frequently after beginning the master's programme. She already knew about ChatGPT and occasionally used it for everyday things, but once the programme started, she found it useful for understanding economics concepts, reading papers, and improving her English, so her use increased. She also used it quite a lot when she had just arrived in Spain and was still adapting to the teaching style.

5. Which AI tools do you use most frequently?

She mainly uses ChatGPT and sometimes Gemini, especially when she wants to compare explanations or get another idea. For literature searches, she also uses Google Scholar and the university library database. She sometimes uses Grammarly or translation tools for language support.

6. For what kinds of academic tasks do you usually use AI?

She uses AI mainly to explain economics and finance concepts, help with difficult parts of academic papers, brainstorm ideas for reports or thesis work, improve English after writing a draft, and understand data-analysis results. For example, she may ask AI how a regression coefficient can be interpreted. She does not use AI to complete the whole analysis.

7. Can you describe a recent situation where AI helped you complete an academic task?

Recently, while working on her thesis, she sometimes used AI when she was unsure how to explain a result. She asked AI for possible interpretations and then checked these ideas against the literature and original sources. She also used AI for some English revision, but made the final decisions about the analysis and conclusions herself.

Section 3. Motivation for Adoption and Continued AI Use

8. What motivated you to start using AI in the first place?

She began using AI more often after starting the master's programme because the coursework involved a large amount of reading and writing in English. AI helped her understand difficult concepts and express ideas more

clearly in English.

9. What made you keep using AI after you first tried it?

The main reason was the immediate feedback. When reading papers or learning a new concept, it is not always possible to ask a professor straight away, but AI can be used at any time and she can keep asking follow-up questions. It is also useful for non-native English speakers, not only for revising sentences but also for explaining why one expression sounds more natural or more appropriate for academic writing.

10. Would you say using AI has become a habit, something you do without thinking much about it?

To some extent, yes. When she comes across a difficult concept, she usually checks the textbook or class notes first and turns to AI if it is still unclear. Asking AI to check the language after finishing a draft has also become a habit. However, she does not ask AI to write the whole answer from the beginning because she feels that would make it easy to lose her own line of thought.

11. Do your classmates or professors' attitudes affect whether you use AI?

Classmates have some influence. For example, they may share useful prompts or explain how they get AI to explain models or compare theories, which encourages her to try new approaches. Professors' attitudes mainly affect how cautious she is. If a professor clearly says AI cannot be used for an assignment, she follows that rule. If AI is allowed, she prefers the professor to explain what kinds of use are acceptable. Even when a professor does not mention AI, she may still use it as a learning tool, but not to replace doing the assignment herself.

12. What makes you continue using AI? Is it mainly because it saves time and improves your work, because you enjoy using it, or for other reasons?

The main reasons are saving time, helping with understanding, and improving language. As an international student, she sometimes first needs to understand the specialised content and then think about how to express it in English, and AI can shorten that process. It can also suggest variables, cases, or explanations she had not considered. She continues using it because it is useful for learning rather than because she finds it entertaining.

13. How easy or difficult was it for you to learn how to use these AI tools effectively?

The difficult part is not getting AI to produce an answer, but judging whether the answer is reliable. AI usually writes very fluently, so even incorrect information can sound convincing. Effective use therefore also requires checking literature, verifying data, and keeping one's own judgement.

14. Do you feel you have the knowledge, skills, and resources you need to use AI tools well for your studies?

Some advanced features require a paid subscription.

Section 4. Perceived Benefits

15. What do you find most useful about generative AI?

She finds it most useful that AI can adjust an explanation to the user's level of understanding. For example, it can first explain an economics concept in simple language, then explain it again in more academic language, and finally give a real-world example. For a non-native English speaker, being able to ask questions repeatedly in this way is convenient because it can feel awkward to ask a professor to explain the same point several times in class.

16. Has AI changed the way you study?

Yes. Previously, when she found a concept difficult, she might search different websites or books for an

explanation. Now she often asks AI first to get a basic understanding and then goes back to the textbook or papers to confirm it. Learning has also become more conversational because she can keep asking “why”, “are there other explanations?”, or “what are the limitations of this theory?”. At the same time, she reminds herself that a clear explanation is not necessarily a correct one.

17. Do you think AI improves your learning? Why?

She thinks it can help, especially with understanding concepts, English expression, and learning efficiency. AI can break complicated content into steps and provide examples from different countries or industries, which makes it easier to connect theory with reality. For international students, it can also reduce some of the language pressure so that more attention can be given to the content itself. However, she thinks the effect still depends on how AI is used. Simply copying an AI answer may help finish an assignment faster, but that does not necessarily mean the student has learned the material.

Section 5. Challenges and Risks

18. Have you ever received incorrect information from AI?

Yes. AI sometimes explains an economic figure very confidently, but after checking the original data she may find that the year, country, or number is wrong. It can also mix up two similar economics concepts. Because of this, she does not directly trust AI when a question involves specific figures, policies, or the latest economic situation.

19. Have you ever noticed AI generating fake references or inaccurate facts?

Yes. On one occasion, she asked AI to recommend literature related to a research topic. The articles looked realistic and included authors, years, and titles. But when she searched Google Scholar, one article did not exist and another had the title and author information mixed up. Since then, she has not used AI-generated references directly. AI can help suggest search keywords, but the actual literature needs to be found through academic databases.

20. What concerns do you have when using AI?

Her biggest concern is accuracy because AI can sound very confident even when it is wrong. She also worries about dependence. If she asks AI immediately every time she has a problem, she may gradually stop trying to solve things herself first.

21. Do you think using AI has reduced the effort you put into thinking through a problem yourself?

Sometimes. This can happen especially in writing: if AI quickly gives a complete and well-structured answer, it is easy to accept it without thinking about other possibilities. To avoid this, she tries to write down her own ideas first before asking AI. She may also ask AI to give an opposing view or point out possible problems in her analysis. She thinks AI can either reduce or encourage thinking, depending on whether it is treated as an “answer provider” or as something to discuss with.

Section 6. Responsible Use and AI Literacy

22. How do you decide whether an AI-generated answer is reliable?

She first checks whether the answer is consistent with theories learned in class and with basic logic. If it involves specific data, laws, policies, or research findings, she looks for the original source. She also pays attention to whether AI can explain the basis for its answer. If it only gives a conclusion without a source that can be checked, she becomes more cautious.

23. Do you usually verify the information provided by AI? How?

Yes. For theories and definitions, she checks textbooks, class materials, or authoritative academic sources. For

literature, she uses Google Scholar and the UAB library database. For economic data, she checks official statistical agencies, the World Bank, the IMF, Eurostat, or relevant national official sources. Sometimes she also asks the same question to different AI tools, but she treats this only as a supplementary check rather than a replacement for original sources.

24. What do you think is an acceptable way to use AI in academic work?

She considers it generally acceptable to use AI to explain difficult concepts, brainstorm ideas, help structure a paper, revise grammar and language, suggest search keywords, give feedback on analysis that has already been completed, or practise presentations and possible questions. The student should still understand the final content and be able to explain why they reached a conclusion. If the university or professor requires AI use to be disclosed, it should be stated honestly.

25. Where do you think students should NOT use AI? Why?

Students should not use AI in exams or assignments where it is explicitly prohibited. They also should not submit AI-generated content as their own original analysis, especially if they do not understand it themselves. Sensitive data, personal information, or research material that has not been authorised should not be entered into public AI systems. She also thinks students should not skip the whole learning process when studying basic methods. For example, they should first understand how regression analysis works instead of simply giving the data to AI and copying its explanation.

26. Have you ever worried that using AI in a particular way could be considered academic dishonesty? What made you think that?

Yes. The clearest example would be asking AI to write an entire report or paper and then submitting it after changing only a few sentences. She sees this as very different from doing the analysis herself and then using AI to improve the language. The student should still understand the work and contribute the main ideas and analysis. It also depends on what the course and professor allow.

Section 7. Reflection and Future Expectations

27. Looking back, do you think AI has changed the way you learn?

Yes. When she has difficulty with language or a concept, she can continue learning independently instead of waiting until the next class or office hour.

28. How do you think AI will influence management and economics education in the future?

She thinks AI will become a normal tool in management and economics education. Some traditional assignments may need to change because AI can already explain a theory or summarise an article quite easily. In the future, teachers may ask students to analyse more recent data, compare different countries or companies, explain why they chose a particular theory, or criticise an AI answer. Class presentations and oral explanations of the analysis process may also become more important. She thinks the important skill will not be avoiding AI completely, but knowing how to question, verify, and improve what AI produces.

29. If your university could improve one thing related to AI, what would you suggest?

She hopes the university can provide clear and consistent rules on AI use. Different professors may have different attitudes, and students are sometimes unsure whether language editing, brainstorming, or structural suggestions need to be disclosed. The university could also offer practical training on topics such as writing prompts, recognising AI hallucinations, verifying references and data, protecting privacy, disclosing AI use in a thesis, and using AI without losing independent thinking.

30. Is there anything else about your experience with generative AI that you think is important but we

haven't discussed?

She sees AI as both a learning tool and a language-support tool. It can help non-native English speakers express ideas they have already developed more clearly, which may make participation in class and academic work somewhat fairer. At the same time, universities should distinguish between language quality and actual analytical ability. Less fluent English does not mean poor understanding of an economic issue, just as fluent language does not necessarily mean genuine understanding. She therefore thinks teachers should pay more attention to students' thinking process, data analysis, oral explanation, and judgement rather than only how polished the final text looks.

Appendix B. Survey Questionnaire and Variable Treatment

B.1 Survey Questionnaire

Appendix B presents the full survey instrument as administered, comprising 46 items across six sections (A: background information; B: patterns of use; C: UTAUT2 constructs; D: perceived benefits and concerns; E: AI literacy; F: open-ended response). The questionnaire was administered bilingually in Chinese and English; the English version is reproduced here.

A Survey of Master's Students in Business and Management Programmes

Purpose of the Study

This study examines how master's students in business and management-related programmes use generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, Copilot, and Gemini) in their academic work. It is conducted by Dilidaer, a master's student at the Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, as part of a thesis research project.

What Participation Involves

This survey takes approximately 10 – 15 minutes to complete and covers your use of generative AI tools, your views on this use, and some basic background information.

Voluntary Participation and Right to Withdraw

Participation in this study is entirely voluntary. You may withdraw at any point while completing the survey without providing a reason and without any negative consequences.

Confidentiality and Data Processing

Your responses will be collected anonymously; this study does not collect any information, such as your name or email address, that could be used to identify you. Dilidaer is responsible for processing the data collected in this survey. Data will be stored securely and used solely for the purposes of this research, retained for the duration of the thesis project and for 6 months afterwards, after which it will be securely deleted.

Risks and Benefits

Participation in this study involves no risks beyond those encountered in everyday life. Your participation will contribute to a better understanding of how generative AI is used in management education, informing future educational practice.

Contact Information

If you have any questions about this research, please contact:

Dilidaer (Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona) ashesto0217@163.com

Consent Statement

By continuing, you confirm that you have read and understood the information above, that you are a master's student in a business or management-related programme, and that you consent to participating under these conditions, with your anonymised responses being used for the academic purposes of this research.

Section A. About You

This section collects basic background information.

1. What is your current programme?

Open text

2. What was your undergraduate field of study?

Open text

3. Do you have professional work experience related to your current studies (e.g. an internship or a job)?

Yes / No

4. Before starting this programme, had you used generative AI tools?

Never / Occasionally / Regularly

5. What is your nationality?

Open text

6. What is your gender?

☐ Female

☐ Male

☐ Prefer not to say

☐ other

7. What is your age?

Open text

8. Is the language of instruction in your programme your first language?

Yes / No

Section B. Your Use of Generative AI

This section addresses RQ1: how students use generative AI tools.

9. Which generative AI tools do you use? (select all that apply)

ChatGPT / Microsoft Copilot / Google Gemini / Claude / DeepSeek / Doubao / Yuanbao / Other (please specify)

10. How often do you use generative AI for academic purposes?

7-point frequency scale, adapted from Strzelecki (2024) and Ravšelj et al. (2025): Never / Once a month / Several times a month / Once a week / Several times a week / Once a day / Several times a day

11. Which of the following do you typically use generative AI for? (select all that apply)

Brainstorming ideas / Summarising readings / Explaining difficult concepts / Finding or checking references / Improving grammar or language / Drafting written work / Interpreting data or analysis results / Preparing presentations / Exam revision / Other (please specify)

12. When did you first start using generative AI tools for academic work?

Before this programme / At the start of this programme / During this programme, after it had already started

Section C. Your Experience Using AI Tools

This section addresses RQ1: the factors associated with adopting and continuing to use generative AI, based on the UTAUT2 model (Venkatesh et al., 2012). Items 13–28 use a 5-point scale: Strongly Disagree / Disagree / Neutral / Agree / Strongly Agree.

Performance Expectancy

13. Using generative AI helps me complete academic tasks more efficiently.

14. Using generative AI improves the quality of my academic work.

Effort Expectancy

15. When I first started using generative AI tools, it did not take much time or effort to learn the basics (e.g. typing a question, submitting a prompt, or navigating the interface).

16. In my day-to-day use, interacting with generative AI tools is quick and straightforward (e.g. getting a response, refining a question, or switching between tasks).

Social Influence

17. People who are important to me (classmates, professors) think I should use generative AI.

18. My professors' stated policies affect how I use generative AI for coursework.

Facilitating Conditions

19. I have the devices I need to use generative AI for my studies.

20. I have the knowledge and skills necessary to use generative AI effectively for my studies.

21. I have reliable access to the AI tools I need, without being limited by factors such as network restrictions or subscription costs.

Hedonic Motivation

22. Using generative AI is enjoyable.

23. I find it interesting to explore what generative AI tools can do.

Price Value

24. The benefits I get from generative AI are worth any costs involved (e.g. paid subscriptions).

25. Compared to what I get out of it, generative AI is reasonably priced (including free options).

Habit

26. Using generative AI has become a habit for me.

27. I use generative AI without thinking much about it.

Behavioural Intention

28. I intend to keep using generative AI for my academic work in the future.

Section D. Perceived Benefits and Concerns

This section addresses RQ2: what benefits and concerns students associate with their use of generative AI. Items use a 5-point scale: Strongly Disagree / Disagree / Neutral / Agree / Strongly Agree.

Perceived Benefits

- 29. Generative AI helps me understand difficult concepts.**
- 30. Generative AI helps me save time on academic tasks.**
- 31. Generative AI exposes me to ideas or perspectives I would not have thought of myself.**
- 32. Generative AI has improved the quality of my written academic work.**

Perceived Concerns

- 33. I am concerned about the accuracy of AI-generated content.**
- 34. I am concerned about becoming too dependent on AI for academic tasks.**
- 35. I am concerned about privacy when using AI tools (e.g. entering personal or confidential information).**
- 36. I am concerned that not all students have equal access to AI tools (e.g. due to cost or regional restrictions).**
- 37. Using generative AI has reduced the effort I put into thinking through problems on my own.**

Section E. How You Engage with AI Outputs

This section addresses RQ3: how students' reported use of generative AI relates to their level of AI literacy, drawing on the framework of Ng et al. (2021). Items use a 5-point scale: Strongly Disagree / Disagree / Neutral / Agree / Strongly Agree.

Understanding AI's Limitations

- 38. I understand that generative AI can produce inaccurate or fabricated information (e.g. false references).**
- 39. I am aware of specific situations where generative AI has given me incorrect information in my field of study.**

Critical Evaluation and Verification

- 40. I verify AI-generated information against reliable sources (e.g. academic databases, official statistics) before using it.**
- 41. I revise or edit AI-generated content rather than using it exactly as it is given.**
- 42. When I am unsure about an AI-generated answer, I compare responses from different AI tools.**

Responsible Use and Academic Integrity

- 43. I disclose or acknowledge my use of AI when required by my coursework or programme.**
- 44. Even when I use AI, I make sure that what I submit reflects my own understanding and analysis.**
- 45. I am aware of where using AI in a particular way could be considered academic dishonesty in my programme.**

Section F. Final Comments

- 46. Is there anything else about your use of generative AI in your studies that you think is important but wasn't covered in this survey?**

Open text, optional

Thank you for completing this survey. Your responses are greatly appreciated and will directly contribute to

this research.

B.2 Measurement Construction and Variable Treatment

Measure	Item(s)	Final Treatment
Tool Breadth	Q9	Number of AI tools selected
Academic Use Frequency	Q10	Seven-point ordinal measure
Task Breadth	Q11	Number of academic activities selected
Performance Expectancy	Q13, Q14	Mean of two items
Effort Expectancy	Q15, Q16	Mean of two items
Social Influence	Q17, Q18	Analysed as two separate items
Facilitating Conditions	Q19, Q20, Q21	Mean of three items
Hedonic Motivation	Q22, Q23	Mean of two items
Price Value	Q24, Q25	Mean of two items
Habit	Q26, Q27	Mean of two items
Behavioural Intention	Q28	Single item
Perceived Benefits	Q29-Q32	Mean of four items
Perceived Concerns	Q33-Q37	Mean of five items
Awareness of AI Limitations	Q38, Q39	Mean of two items
Critical Engagement with AI Outputs	Q40, Q41	Mean of two items
Cross-tool comparison	Q42	Single item
Disclosure of AI use	Q43	Single item
Ensuring own understanding	Q44	Single item
Awareness of academic-dishonesty boundary	Q45	Single item

Appendix C. Stata Do-file

```

clear all
set more off
capture log close
log using "final_thesis_analysis.log", text replace

*****
* 1. IMPORT DATA
*****
local excel_file "survey data.xlsx"
local sheet_name "TextData_20260811061652_1"

import excel using "`excel_file'", sheet("`sheet_name'") firstrow clear

count
assert _N == 134
describe

*****
* 2. CONVERT ANALYSIS VARIABLES TO NUMERIC FORMAT
*****
foreach v of varlist Q7 Q9_1-Q9_8 Q10 Q11_1-Q11_10 Q13-Q45 {
    capture confirm numeric variable `v'
    if _rc {
        destring `v', replace
    }
}

```

```

    }
}

*****
* 3. BASIC DATA CHECKS
*****
misstable summarize Q7 Q9_1-Q9_8 Q10 Q11_1-Q11_10 Q13-Q45

foreach v of varlist Q9_1-Q9_8 {
    assert inlist(`v',0,1) if !missing(`v')
}

foreach v of varlist Q11_1-Q11_10 {
    assert inlist(`v',0,1) if !missing(`v')
}

assert inrange(Q10,1,7) if !missing(Q10)

foreach v of varlist Q13-Q45 {
    assert inrange(`v',1,5) if !missing(`v')
}

*****
* 4. CREATE BACKGROUND VARIABLES
*****
capture drop age
gen age = Q7
label variable age "Age"

capture drop previous_ai
gen previous_ai = .
replace previous_ai = 1 if strpos(ustrlower(Q4),"never") > 0
replace previous_ai = 2 if strpos(ustrlower(Q4),"occasionally") > 0
replace previous_ai = 3 if strpos(ustrlower(Q4),"regularly") > 0
label define prevai 1 "Never" 2 "Occasionally" 3 "Regularly", replace
label values previous_ai prevai

capture drop firstlanguage
gen firstlanguage = .
replace firstlanguage = 1 if strpos(ustrlower(Q8),"yes") > 0
replace firstlanguage = 0 if strpos(ustrlower(Q8),"no") > 0
label define yesno 0 "No" 1 "Yes", replace
label values firstlanguage yesno

*****
* 5. LABEL ACADEMIC AI-USE FREQUENCY
*****
label define freq7 1 "Never" 2 "Once a month" 3 "Several times a month" 4 "Once a week" 5
"Several times a week" 6 "Once a day" 7 "Several times a day", replace
label values Q10 freq7

*****
* 6. CREATE AI-USE BREADTH VARIABLES
*****
capture drop tool_breadth task_breadth
egen tool_breadth = rowtotal(Q9_1-Q9_8)
egen task_breadth = rowtotal(Q11_1-Q11_10)

summarize tool_breadth task_breadth

*****
* 7. TABLE 4.1 - CHARACTERISTICS OF THE SURVEY SAMPLE
*****
tab Q6, missing

```

```

summarize age, detail
tab previous_ai, missing
tab firstlanguage, missing
tab Q3, missing

*****
* 8. TABLE 4.2 - PATTERNS OF GENERATIVE AI USE
*****
foreach v of varlist Q9_1-Q9_8 {
    tab `v', missing
}

tab Q10, missing
summarize Q10

foreach v of varlist Q11_1-Q11_10 {
    tab `v', missing
}

tab Q12, missing
summarize tool_breadth task_breadth

*****
* 9. TABLE 4.3 - ITEM-LEVEL DESCRIPTIVE STATISTICS
*****
tabstat Q13-Q27 Q29-Q41, statistics(n min max mean sd) columns(statistics)
tabstat Q42-Q45, statistics(n min max mean sd) columns(statistics)

*****
* 10. RELIABILITY ANALYSIS
*****
alpha Q13 Q14, item std
pwcorr Q13 Q14, sig obs

alpha Q15 Q16, item std
pwcorr Q15 Q16, sig obs

alpha Q17 Q18, item std
pwcorr Q17 Q18, sig obs

alpha Q19 Q20 Q21, item std

alpha Q22 Q23, item std
pwcorr Q22 Q23, sig obs

alpha Q24 Q25, item std
pwcorr Q24 Q25, sig obs

alpha Q26 Q27, item std
pwcorr Q26 Q27, sig obs

alpha Q29 Q30 Q31 Q32, item std
alpha Q33 Q34 Q35 Q36 Q37, item std

alpha Q38 Q39, item std
pwcorr Q38 Q39, sig obs

alpha Q40 Q41 Q42, item std
alpha Q40 Q41, item std
pwcorr Q40 Q41, sig obs

alpha Q43 Q44 Q45, item std
alpha Q38-Q45, item std

```

```

*****
* 11. EXPLORATORY FACTOR ANALYSIS — AI LITERACY
*****
factor Q38-Q45, pcf
screeplot
estat kmo
factor Q38-Q45, pcf factors(3)
rotate, promax

*****
* 12. CREATE FINAL COMPOSITE VARIABLES
*****
capture drop PE EE FC HM PV HABIT BI BENEFIT CONCERN AI_limit AI_critical

egen PE = rowmean(Q13 Q14)
egen EE = rowmean(Q15 Q16)
egen FC = rowmean(Q19 Q20 Q21)
egen HM = rowmean(Q22 Q23)
egen PV = rowmean(Q24 Q25)
egen HABIT = rowmean(Q26 Q27)
gen BI = Q28
egen BENEFIT = rowmean(Q29 Q30 Q31 Q32)
egen CONCERN = rowmean(Q33 Q34 Q35 Q36 Q37)
egen AI_limit = rowmean(Q38 Q39)
egen AI_critical = rowmean(Q40 Q41)

*****
* 13. AI-LITERACY DESCRIPTIVE STATISTICS — SECTION 4.2.6
*****
tabstat AI_limit AI_critical Q42 Q43 Q44 Q45, statistics(n min max mean sd)
columns(statistics)

*****
* 14. TABLE 4.4 — UTAUT2 DESCRIPTIVES AND CORRELATIONS WITH BI
*****
tabstat PE EE Q17 Q18 FC HM PV HABIT BI, statistics(n mean sd min max) columns(statistics)
pwcrr PE EE Q17 Q18 FC HM PV HABIT BI, sig obs

*****
* 15. TABLE 4.5 — MULTIPLE REGRESSION PREDICTING BI
*****
regress BI PE EE Q17 Q18 FC HM PV HABIT, beta
estat vif

*****
* 16. TABLE 4.6 — PERCEIVED BENEFITS AND CONCERNS
*****
tabstat Q29-Q37, statistics(n min max mean sd) columns(statistics)
tabstat BENEFIT CONCERN, statistics(n min max mean sd) columns(statistics)
pwcrr BENEFIT CONCERN BI, sig obs

*****
* 17. TABLE 4.7 — SPEARMAN CORRELATIONS FOR RQ3
*****
* Exploratory analysis; no formal multiple-comparison correction was applied.
spearman Q10 AI_limit AI_critical Q42 Q43 Q44 Q45, stats(rho p)
spearman tool_breadth AI_limit AI_critical Q42 Q43 Q44 Q45, stats(rho p)
spearman task_breadth AI_limit AI_critical Q42 Q43 Q44 Q45, stats(rho p)

*****
* 18. TABLE 4.8 — RQ3 REGRESSION MODELS
*****
regress AI_limit Q10 tool_breadth task_breadth, beta
estat vif

```

```
regress AI_critical Q10 tool_breadth task_breadth, beta
estat vif
```

```
*****
```

*** 19. OPTIONAL OPEN-ENDED RESPONSE (Q46)**

```
*****
```

```
list Q46 if ustrtrim(Q46)!="", noobs clean
```

```
*****
```

*** 20. SAVE FINAL ANALYTICAL DATASET**

```
*****
```

```
save "survey_134_final.dta", replace
log close
```

Appendix D. Declaration and Log of Artificial Intelligence (AI) Tool Use

Declaration

I, Dilidaer Nijati, declare that in the completion of this Master's Dissertation, I have followed the ethical and academic guidelines established by the university regarding the use of technological tools, including Artificial Intelligence (AI). For transparency, I disclose below my own use of AI tools in preparing this thesis.

I used AI tools as supporting tools for selected tasks, including language editing, clarification and organization of text, translation, Stata coding assistance and clarification of methodological concepts. The research questions, literature selection and verification, research design, data collection, analytical decision and interpretation of the data, and the conclusions presented in this dissertation are my own work. All AI-assisted outputs were reviewed, revised, and, where relevant, verified against the original sources or research data before being incorporated into the dissertation.

AI Use Log

Date	Tool	Purpose	What the AI tool was used for	My own work
June 2026	ChatGPT	Language and academic writing support	Used to identify grammar problems, improve clarity, and suggest more appropriate academic wording in	The original ideas, arguments, cited sources, and substantive content were produced by the author. Suggested

			selected passages drafted by the author.	wording was reviewed and revised before use.
July 2026	ChatGPT	Interview guide refinement	Used to review semi-structured interview questions for clarity, repetition, neutrality, and comprehensibility.	The research objectives, interview design, question selection, interviews, and interpretation of responses were completed by the author.
July 2026	ChatGPT	Questionnaire wording and bilingual support	Used to suggest clearer and more neutral wording for selected questionnaire items and to assist with Chinese-English translation while preserving the intended meaning.	The constructs, questionnaire structure, final item selection, distribution, and data collection were determined and carried out by the author. Translations and wording were checked and adjusted by the author.
August 2026	ChatGPT	Structure and coherence review	Used to review selected sections for logical flow, paragraph organization, clarity, and repetition without introducing new evidence or sources.	The structure of the dissertation, literature-based arguments, source selection, and final organization were decided by the author.
August 2026	ChatGPT	Stata coding assistance for data analysis	ChatGPT was used to check Stata code for data preparation and selected statistical analyses, including descriptive statistics, reliability analysis, exploratory factor analysis, correlation analysis, and regression analysis.	Ran the code in Stata, checked the outputs against the dataset, and interpreted and reported the results.

Examples of Prompts Used

Language editing

Prompt: “Please improve the academic English and clarity of the following paragraph while preserving its original meaning and citations.”

Description of use: Used to improve grammar, clarity, and academic wording in text originally drafted by the author.

Interview questions

Prompt: “Please review these semi-structured interview questions and identify any questions that may be unclear, repetitive, or leading.”

Description of use: Used to improve the clarity and neutrality of the interview guide. The final questions were selected and revised by the author.

Questionnaire wording

Prompt: “Please review the wording of these survey questions and suggest clearer and more neutral formulations without changing the constructs being measured.”

Description of use: Used to improve readability and reduce ambiguity in selected questionnaire items. Final wording was determined by the author.

Translation

Prompt: “Please translate the following questionnaire items from Chinese into English while maintaining their original meaning and an appropriate academic tone.”

Description of use: Used as translation support for the bilingual questionnaire. The translation was subsequently reviewed and adjusted by the author.

Methodological clarification

Prompt: “Please explain how descriptive statistics can be used to summarize the results of this questionnaire.”

Description of use: Used to clarify methodological concepts. The analysis and interpretation of the study data were performed and verified by the author.

Structure and coherence

Prompt: “Please check the organization of this section and suggest how the paragraphs could be arranged more logically without adding new information or sources.”

Description of use: Used to identify possible improvements in organization and coherence. The final structure and substantive content were decided by the author.

I clarify that all sources used to obtain information have been properly cited and that the use of AI has not replaced my own analytical capacity or the original work presented in this

dissertation. I am aware that failing to make this declaration or lacking transparency in the use of AI may be subject to the university's academic regulations.